



TOKYO SHOW BRINGS HOME HARD TRUTH FOR INDIAN ATHLETICS

Sachin Yadav's personal best in javelin throw was the **lone bright spot** as India failed to win a medal at the 2025 World Championships in Tokyo. What does this mean for the road ahead?

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Naval Singh, coach of Indian javelin thrower Sachin Yadav, had mixed feelings at the conclusion of the men's javelin throw competition at the 2025 World Championships. On the evening of September 18, belying all pre-event expectations, the 25-year-old Sachin nearly pulled off one of the biggest upsets in Indian track and field history. He threw a Personal Best of 86.27m to briefly claim the silver-medal position before eventually slipping just off the podium and finishing fourth. Even without a medal on his World Championships debut, Sachin outperformed some of the sport's biggest names – world leader Julian Weber and Olympic champion Arshad Nadeem both finished behind him. From an Indian perspective, perhaps more significant was the fact that Sachin finished ahead of Neeraj Chopra – the first time in eight

So near, yet so far: Sachin Yadav's best of 86.27m placed him fourth in the javelin throw final. AP